

The 6:15

FRIDAY · OCTOBER 2, 2026

NO. 23

THE BOARD

CALENDAR · NEXT 10 DAYS

Fri 10/2, 8:30a ET	September Nonfarm Payrolls (BLS) — not yet released as of writing
Fri 10/2, 8:00p ET	Northwestern hosts Penn State (3-0), new Ryan Field opener — 100 years to the day after the original stadium's first game
Sat 10/3	Yankees open ALDS vs. Toronto Blue Jays (date/time unconfirmed)
Sun 10/4	OPEC+ 68th JMMC meeting (virtual)
Mon 10/5	Knicks preseason opens at Philadelphia
Tue 10/14, 8:30a ET	September CPI
Wed 10/15, 8:30a ET	September PPI

Standing: FOMC next meets Oct. 27-28; funding runs on the Dec. 11 CR, no shutdown risk [continuity]. US-China truce to Jan. 10 unchanged [continuity]. No new frontier-AI release or rocket launch verified this run; Starship's next flight date still unconfirmed [continuity].

METRICS · ET UNLESS NOTED

Brent / WTI	~\$91.93 (+0.34%) (single-sourced, unreconciled vs. yesterday's \$100.36) / not sourced this run (not sourced)
2y / 10y / 30y	4.91% / 5.32% / 5.66%, carried from yesterday 6a ET (not refreshed)
DXY	101.91, carried from yesterday (not refreshed)
S&P / Nasdaq futures / VIX / gold / Asia-Europe closes / retail gas	not independently confirmed this run (not sourced)
Nike FQ1'27 (actual)	EPS \$0.72 vs. ~\$0.13 cons.; rev \$10.97B vs. ~\$10.85B cons.; shares -3.5% premarket

No Brent/WTI settle reconciled this morning; today's Brent read is single-sourced and markedly below yesterday's \$100.36 — treated as unconfirmed pending a second source or settle. Rates, DXY, futures, VIX, gold, overseas closes and gas are carried from the prior issue where no fresher read was located; see colophon.

HORMUZ COUNTERS

Transits	3.17/day avg., first 6 days of Sept. vs. 85.5/day 2025 norm (IMF PortWatch) — 96% decline; Aug. avg. 4.71/day
Vessels holding	135 AIS-visible, 23:50 UTC Sept. 30, carried from issue No. 22 (not refreshed)
Strikes, 24h	None independently confirmed this run; no new UKMTO notice located for Oct. 1-2 (absence not confirmation of a quiet night)
War-risk premia	7.5%-10% of hull value (trade-press/insurance-market reporting this week), consistent with the ~10% figure carried since issue No. 21

Transit counts (PortWatch, lagged), AIS-based stranded-vessel counts (same-day, volatile) and war-risk premia (insurance-market reporting, periodic, vendor-specific) measure different things over different windows; never averaged or differenced here.

TRANSACTIONS

Yankees	Beat Red Sox 4-0 in decisive ALWC Gm 3 Thursday night; Red Sox eliminated; advance to ALDS vs. Blue Jays
Knicks	No reported moves in the last 24 hours
Northwestern	No reported moves since the Sept. 25 loss at Indiana

LEAD

NIKE'S TARIFF-CREDIT BEAT, AND A FED SIGNAL THAT HASN'T BEEN RETESTED

Nike's "beat" is a tariff check, not a turnaround — and yesterday's PCE-driven Fed signal still hasn't been retested by a fresher market read

Nike's fiscal Q1 2027 results, released after Thursday's close, are a useful lesson in reading past a headline number. GAAP diluted EPS came in at \$0.72 against a roughly \$0.13 consensus — a beat so large it would normally be a market-moving surprise. [fact] It isn't, because \$986 million of it is a one-time benefit tied to the expected recovery of tariffs paid under the International Emergency Economic

Powers Act — the same legal authority now before the Supreme Court in the pending tariff case. That one item added roughly 900 basis points of gross margin and about \$0.52 per share. [fact] Strip it out and adjusted EPS lands near \$0.20, still ahead of the \$0.12-\$0.13 ex-item Street estimate, but a far more ordinary beat. Revenue of \$10.97 billion against a \$10.85 billion consensus is the cleaner read on the underlying business, and it's a modest beat, not a blowout. [fact] The market treated it that way: shares fell roughly 3.5% in premarket trading despite the headline numbers. [fact] The mechanism is specific to companies with large exposure to tariffs the administration has signaled it expects to refund or reverse — expect more of these one-time, non-recurring "tariff recovery" line items to show up in retail and apparel earnings over the next two quarters as IEEPA litigation plays out, each one requiring the same discount. [read] Nike's own tariff exposure is still live and forward-looking regardless of the one-time credit: roughly half its footwear sourcing runs through Vietnam, which carries a 46% tariff rate, against 18% for China-sourced goods, and prior guidance had put the gross tariff hit at \$1 billion with a margin headwind raised once already from about 75 to 120 basis points. [continuity] None of that changes with yesterday's print.

The more load-bearing macro story is still Wednesday's August PCE data and the roughly 35-37-point swing it produced in Fed-hike odds for the Oct. 27-28 meeting, reported in this brief's previous issue. [continuity] That move hasn't been retested with a fresher snapshot: this run could not locate a rate-odds reading newer than late Wednesday/early Thursday, so the roughly mid-30s hike probability carried in issue No. 22 stands as the last confirmed data point, not a number reconfirmed this morning. [flag] That matters because

today's own calendar carries the heavier catalyst: September nonfarm payrolls at 8:30a ET, not yet released as of writing. A soft payrolls print on top of Wednesday's cool PCE would reinforce the hold case the market has already started pricing; a firm one reopens the hike debate on a second channel, independent of what crude does. [read] Crude itself is harder to read this morning: a single, unreconciled source put Brent near \$91.93, well below yesterday's reported \$100.36, with no settle located and no corroborating quote found — this brief is not treating that gap as a real overnight move until a second source or a settle confirms it. [flag] The other overnight story, the Yankees' 4-0 elimination of the Red Sox, is lower stakes than all of the above but lands in the same 24 hours as a reminder that October in New York runs on three clocks at once: the Fed's, the market's, and the sports calendar's — and only two of those have a scheduled release today.

ECONOMICS

September ISM Manufacturing PMI printed 54.6, below the roughly 55.2 consensus and down from August's 55.6 — an eight-month streak above the 50 expansion threshold, but the New Orders Index fell to 53.7 from 56.7 and Backlog of Orders dropped to 51.8, both signaling the pace of expansion is slowing even as the headline stays positive. [NEW, fact] One source's sector labeling was inconsistent (referencing "Q3" rather than the September monthly print); this brief reads it as the September figure pending confirmation, consistent with the Oct. 1 calendar slot. [flag] The more consequential release lands at 8:30a ET today: September nonfarm payrolls, not yet out as of writing. [continuity] August payrolls had rebounded sharply to +162,000 after a 23,000 July decline, with the unemployment rate steady at 4.1%; today's print is read against

Wednesday's cooler PCE as the second data point the Fed will weigh into the Oct. 27-28 meeting — a soft number reinforces the hold case already building in rate-odds markets, a firm one reopens the hike debate independent of what crude or Hormuz does. [read]

BUSINESS

Nike's print (above) is the session's dominant corporate story; no other earnings of comparable size reported overnight. [continuity] The IEEPA tariff-refund dynamic behind Nike's one-time benefit is worth watching across the retail/apparel complex into year-end as the Supreme Court case proceeds — any company with meaningful exposure to tariffs collected under that authority could post a similar one-time credit, and this brief will flag each one as it appears rather than taking headline EPS at face value. [read] No new corporate-bond, buyback, or M&A items verified this run. [flag]

GEOPOLITICS

Russia launched 49 Shahed-type drones, an Oniks anti-ship missile and four Iskander-M/KN-23 ballistic missiles at Ukraine overnight Wednesday into Thursday, from Millerovo, Bryansk, occupied Crimea and Russia's Oryol region (Ukrainian Air Force). [continuity, fact] Ukrainian air defenses intercepted or neutralized 44 of the 49 drones by mid-morning local time; a guided aerial bomb struck Kharkiv, injuring six (five hospitalized) and igniting fires at a city market and nearby residential buildings. [continuity, fact] No new confirmed Houthi-Saudi exchange since Sept. 26; the Makkah Joint Defense Agreement stands. [continuity]

IRAN & HORMUZ

No new confirmed development this run on the US counter-proposal Washington sent to Tehran via Qatari mediators Wednesday, nor on Iran's Cabinet response; neither side has disclosed terms as of writing. [continuity, flag] No new UKMTO-logged strike located for the Oct. 1-2 window beyond issue No. 22's Tuesday-night three-tanker report; absence of a new report is not confirmation of a quiet night, only that this run found no fresher notice. [flag] Transit data remains the most-lagged counter: IMF PortWatch's most recent published read is the six-day September average of 3.17/day against an 85.5/day 2025 norm — a 96% decline, with August at 4.71/day — no later daily figure has been published as of this run. [continuity] War-risk premia held in the 7.5%-10% of hull-value range per this week's trade-press reporting, consistent with the ~10% fleet-wide figure this brief has carried since issue No. 21; the per-transit dollar estimate (~\$10M on a \$100M tanker) was not refreshed this run.

[flag] Net: the diplomatic track (counter-proposal) and the physical track (transits, strikes) are both running on stale data this morning; neither should be read as having moved until a same-day source confirms it.

SPORTS

Yankees	Beat Red Sox 4-0 in decisive ALWC Gm 3 Thursday night, Yankee Stadium; Red Sox eliminated. Advance to ALDS vs. Toronto Blue Jays — Gm 1 date/time unconfirmed.
Knicks	No game; preseason opens Mon. 10/5 at Philadelphia.
Northwestern	2-1, hosts Penn State (3-0) tonight, 8:00p ET, Ryan Field (new-stadium opener).

Continuity. Cut from issue No. 22 as unmoved or superseded: the Tampa Bay ALDS-opponent assumption (Yankees instead drew Toronto); Politics and Technology (nothing new located this run — dropped rather than padded). Not refreshed this run: 2Y/10Y/30Y yields, DXY, S&P/Nasdaq futures, VIX, gold, Asia/Europe closes, retail gas, Hormuz vessel-holding count, Hormuz war-risk per-transit dollar figure, Fed-hike-odds snapshot (last confirmed reading is issue No. 22's), WTI. Watch for next issue: today's 8:30a payrolls print and its effect on hike odds; whether Brent's unreconciled ~\$91.93 read holds up against a settle; Yankees-Blue Jays ALDS Gm 1 details; Iran counter-proposal response; tonight's Northwestern-Penn State result.

Unverified figures are marked in red above. WTI not sourced; 2Y/10Y/30Y, DXY, futures, VIX, gold, overseas closes and gas carried from prior issues; Brent's ~\$91.93 read is single-sourced and unreconciled against yesterday's \$100.36, no settle located; Fed-hike-odds snapshot is issue No. 22's last confirmed reading; Hormuz vessel-holding count and war-risk per-transit figure carried from issue No. 22/21; no fresher UKMTO strike notice located for Oct. 1-2; ALDS Gm 1 date/time unconfirmed. Nothing was estimated or filled from memory.